July 2014 during Operation Protective Edge he tweeted, "The big question is—if I lived in #Gaza would I fire a rocket?—probably yes."[35] It is apparent that Ward learned nothing from the Liberal Democrat Party's choice to respond to his Holocaust inversion by analysing it in terms of the need for language to be "precise" and "proportionate." He did not even understand the meaning of the "precise" and "proportionate" requirement. Alistair Carmichael responded to Ward's Apartheid state tweet by temporarily withdrawing his whip on the grounds that "questioning the continued existence of the State of Israel fails the test of language that is 'proportionate and precise.'"[36] Similarly, the party's current Chief Whip, Don Foster, found that Ward's July 2014 Gaza rocket tweet was neither "precise" nor "proportionate" and asked him to ensure that all future comments would be difficult to misinterpret (that is, be "precise") and condemn violence from both sides (that is, be "proportionate").[37]

One has to wonder why the Liberal Democrat Party did not treat Ward's Holocaust inversion as a case of antisemitism and discipline him accordingly. There are several possible explanations. First, I was personally told by Alistair Carmichael in September 2013 that he had never heard of the EUMC Working Definition. I found this to be a disappointing admission of ignorance, given Carmichael's senior role in the Coalition Government, the fact that he was (and is) a member of the Liberal Democrat Friends of Israel, and that he was charged with the responsibility of responding to Ward's comments by considering whether or not to remove the Party whip from him. I subsequently e-mailed Carmichael a copy of the EUMC Definition, together with an explanatory note but received no acknowledgment. I can only assume that his failure to respond was caused, despite its purpose being made clear to him, by a disinterest in the definition. I also assume that Nick Clegg and Simon Hughes, even though more senior to Carmichael in the Party, are either similarly ignorant, or not prepared to be influenced by it.

Second, there is often deliberate obfuscation about what counts as antisemitism.[38] This is primarily because of the desire to distinguish hatred of Israel from antisemitism on account of the shame attached to anti-Jewish hostility.[39] This is one possible explanation for the Liberal Democrat Party's choice not to view Ward's Holocaust inversion as antisemitic. It is clear from a reply to my complaint about Ward from Nick Clegg's office that the Liberal Democrat Party did not have any problem with Ward's political position on Israel. They wanted to preserve for him and other Party members (some of whom support the Palestine Solidarity Campaign) the right to strongly criticise Israel without being labelled antisemitic. I quote from Clegg's reply:

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